Barthez Kenwou — Brand Guidelines
Visual system for portfolio, blog, social posts & publication assets
Aligned with `src/index.css` · 2026-10-10

Brand	Hover	Ink	Paper	White	Sheen
#532791	#451F7A	#121217	#FAFAFA	#FFFFFF	#B9A0E3

Brand guidelines — Barthez Kenwou

Visual system for the portfolio, blog, social posts, covers, and any publication asset.

Source of truth in code: `src/index.css` · `tailwind.config.ts`

Use these values everywhere (Figma, Canva, Notion, LinkedIn, OG images). Do not invent parallel palettes.

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1. Positioning

Axis	Direction
Tone	Technical, calm, precise — engineer / builder, not agency flash
Surfaces	Cold neutrals (slight blue-gray). **No violet tint** on backgrounds
Accent	Deep violet for CTAs, links, focus, key highlights
Motion	Sparse, purposeful (progress, sticky chrome). No glow spam
Density	Airy prose, clear hierarchy, few chrome borders

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2. Color — quick kit (copy these hex)

2.1 Always keep these five (brand kit)

Role	Hex	Use
Brand / CTA	`#532791`	Buttons, links (light), focus ring, key accent
Brand hover	`#451F7A`	Hover / pressed CTA (light)
Ink	`#121217`	Primary text on light surfaces
Paper	`#FAFAFA`	Page background (light)
Card / white	`#FFFFFF`	Cards, panels, editorial frames

Spectrum helpers (gradients, decorative bars — already in CSS):

Token	Hex
Spectrum deep	`#5A2A9D`
Spectrum darker	`#2D2768`
Spectrum sheen	`#B9A0E3`

2.2 Light mode (default for print / Canva / LinkedIn)

Token	Hex	Hex (alt)	Role
`background`	`#FAFAFA`		Page
`foreground`	`#121217`		Body text
`card`	`#FFFFFF`		Elevated surface
`primary` / `brand`	`#532791`		CTA fill, links, ring
`brand-hover`	`#451F7A`		CTA hover
`primary-foreground`	`#FFFFFF`		Text on brand
`muted` / `secondary`	`#EFEFF1`		Soft fill, chips bg
`muted-foreground`	`#2F2F37`		Secondary copy (still strong contrast)
`border` / `input`	`#D3D3D9`		Hairlines, inputs
`destructive`	`#B81E1E`		Errors only

Chart / secondary violet steps (light): `#532791` · `#6946A4` · `#565661` · `#747481` · `#9A9AA2`

2.3 Dark mode

Token	Hex	Role
`background`	`#050505`	Page
`foreground`	`#EFEFF1`	Body text
`card`	`#0E0E10`	Elevated surface
`primary`	`#B49ADF`	**Links / accents only** — readable on black
`brand`	`#5A2A9D`	**Solid CTA fill** (never use lilac `#B49ADF` as a solid button fill)
`brand-hover`	`#6D36BA`	CTA hover
`muted`	`#18181B`	Soft fill
`muted-foreground`	`#9F9FA8`	Secondary copy
`border`	`#26262B`	Hairlines
`destructive`	`#D03939`	Errors

Rule: In dark UI, `primary` (lilac) ≠ `brand` (deep violet CTA). On light, they match (`#532791`).

2.4 Opacity shortcuts (overlays)

Mix	Typical use
Brand @ 28%	Soft highlight / selection
Border @ 40–60%	Quiet dividers in blog chrome
Foreground @ 55–70%	Meta (date, read time, captions)
Foreground @ 85–90%	Supporting paragraphs
Glass light	`rgba(255,255,255,0.86)` + blur 12px
Glass dark	`rgba(14,14,16,0.82)` + blur 12px

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3. Typography

3.1 Families

Role	Family	Source	CSS / Tailwind
Body	**Switzer**	Fontshare	`font-sans`
Display H1	**Clash Display**	Fontshare	`font-display` / `h1`
Section H2+	**Cabinet Grotesk**	Fontshare	`font-heading`
Code / eyebrow	**JetBrains Mono**	Google Fonts	`font-mono` / `.eyebrow`
Greeting only	**Allura**	Google Fonts	`font-greeting`

Fallbacks: `ui-sans-serif` / `ui-monospace` / `cursive` as declared in CSS.

Do not use Inter, Roboto, Arial, or system UI as the designed look for brand assets.

3.2 Type roles & sizes

Role	Font	Weight	Size (ref)	Tracking	Notes
Hero / page H1	Clash Display	700	28–40px (web)	−0.03em	Line-height ~1.05–1.2
Article H1	Clash Display	700	~23→32px responsive	tight	Blog detail title
Section H2	Cabinet Grotesk	600	18–22px	−0.015em	Article sections
Section H3	Cabinet Grotesk	600	16–17px	−0.015em	With left border accent OK
Body	Switzer	400	**17px** (1.0625rem)	0	Line-height **1.65**
Small / meta	Switzer	400–500	11–12px	normal	`foreground` @ 55–70%
Eyebrow / label	JetBrains Mono	500	12px	0.08em	UPPERCASE
Inline code	JetBrains Mono	500	~0.85em	0	Muted chip bg
Caption	Switzer	400	11–12px	0	Centered under figures

3.3 Pairing for off-site designs (Canva / LinkedIn)

If Fontshare fonts are unavailable, approximate:

Need	Acceptable substitute (external only)
Display	Satoshi / General Sans Bold
Heading	Satoshi Medium / Space Pro Medium
Body	Satoshi / Inter *only as last resort*
Mono	JetBrains Mono / IBM Plex Mono

Prefer uploading Clash Display + Cabinet Grotesk + Switzer into the design tool when possible.

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4. Shape, space, chrome

Token	Value	Use
Radius base	**8px** (`0.5rem`)	Cards, inputs, share rail, TOC
Radius sm	4px	Chips, small controls
Radius md	6px	Intermediate
Borders	1px solid `#D3D3D9` (light) / `#26262B` (dark)	Prefer quiet borders over shadows
Shadows	Minimal — soft `shadow-sm` max	No multi-layer glow
Content max	~ `max-w-6xl` page / prose column	Blog: 8/12 cols content, 3–4 TOC
Page padding	12–32px responsive	Keep generous bottom on mobile (sticky CTA)

Cards: use sparingly. Prefer border + background, not heavy elevation. Interactive surfaces may use a light card; decorative content usually should not.

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5. Blog & publication assets

5.1 Cover / Open Graph

Spec	Value
Size	**1200 × 630 px**
Safe zone	Keep title & face inside center 1000×540
Background	`#FAFAFA` or `#050505` — or soft spectrum
Accent bar/line	`#532791` or gradient `#5A2A9D` → `#2D2768`
Title	Clash Display, white or `#121217`
Subline	Switzer / Cabinet, muted ink
Logo / name	Small, corner — never louder than title
Export	JPG or PNG, < ~300 KB when possible

5.2 In-article images

Spec	Guidance
Markdown	`!Caption text`
Admin	Editor **+ image** uploads and inserts at cursor
Public render	Full column width, light border, rounded **md**, caption centered
Max display H	~ `min(70vh, 36rem)` — avoid giant vertical dumps
Badges / shields	Stay **inline** (auto-detected)
Alt = caption	Write a real caption; empty alt = no figcaption

5.3 Editorial chrome (site)

Element	Treatment
Progress bar	2px, `primary`
TOC (desktop)	Sticky, glass/blur, border `@60%`, radius sm
Share rail	Fixed right, glass panel, icon 28–32px
Tags	Quiet text / chips — no rainbow pills
Code blocks	Card border, theme-aware Shiki (light high-contrast / dark dimmed)
Callouts	Left border `primary/50`, no filled purple boxes

5.4 Social share copy (tone)

- Title + short excerpt + URL
- Hashtags: few, CamelCase, no spaces
- No emoji decoration in professional posts unless intentional

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6. Do / Don’t

Do

- Use **deep violet** `#532791` as the single brand accent on light designs
- Keep surfaces **neutral gray** (`#FAFAFA` / `#FFFFFF` / `#EFEFF1`)
- Hierarchy: one display title → one supporting line → one CTA
- Prefer borders and spacing over shadows and glow
- Match light/dark rules when designing UI screenshots

Don’t

- Purple-on-white gradient wallpaper as the whole brand
- Cream / terracotta / “AI default” palettes

- Flat Inter + purple button as a substitute identity
- Lilac (`#B49ADF`) as a solid CTA on dark mockups — use `#5A2A9D`
- Dense pill clusters, emoji rows, neon glow on cards
- Inset hero media cards when a full-bleed cover is expected

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7. Figma / Canva starter swatches

Paste as solid styles:

```
Brand          #532791
Brand Hover    #451F7A
Spectrum Deep  #5A2A9D
Spectrum Dark  #2D2768
Spectrum Soft  #B9A0E3
Ink            #121217
Muted Ink      #2F2F37
Paper          #FAFAFA
White          #FFFFFF
Soft Fill      #EFEFF1
Border         #D3D3D9
Error          #B81E1E
Dark BG        #050505
Dark Card      #0E0E10
Dark Border    #26262B
Dark Accent    #B49ADF
Dark CTA       #5A2A9D
```

Suggested text styles (name them the same in the file):

1. `Display/H1` — Clash Display Bold 32–40 / −3%
2. `Heading/H2` — Cabinet Grotesk SemiBold 20 / −1.5%
3. `Body/17` — Switzer Regular 17 / 165%
4. `Meta/12` — Switzer Medium 12 / color Muted Ink or 55% Ink
5. `Eyebrow/Mono` — JetBrains Mono 12 UPPERCASE / +8%

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8. CSS variable cheat sheet (dev)

```
/* Light brand CTA */
background: hsl(var(--brand));
color: hsl(var(--brand-foreground));

/* Link / accent (adapts in .dark) */
color: hsl(var(--primary));

/* Surfaces */
background: hsl(var(--background));
color: hsl(var(--foreground));
border-color: hsl(var(--border));
```

Tailwind: `bg-background`, `text-foreground`, `bg-primary`, `text-primary`, `border-border`, `font-display`, `font-heading`, `font-sans`, `font-mono`, `rounded-lg` (= `--radius`).

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9. Maintenance

When changing brand colors or fonts:

1. Update tokens in `src/index.css`
2. Update this document's hex tables
3. Refresh Figma/Canva shared library swatches

Last aligned with code tokens: **2026-10-10**.